

5-Year Plan

Dreams and Obstacles

- What are your biggest dreams for a career in the entertainment industry?
- List them. Say them out loud. Even if you're embarrassed.
- Next to each dream, list the obstacles that stand in the way of that dream.

Examples

- Dream – to perform on Broadway
- Obstacle – I haven't had a professional acting job yet and have only taken one acting class . . . and, um, covid.
- Dream – to be a sought-after SFX makeup designer for horror films
- Obstacle – I don't have any connections to the film industry . . . and, ah, covid.
- Dream – to stage manage a touring band
- Obstacle – I have no idea how a person trains for that . . . and . . . covid.

Real-Life Dreams

Most artists fail in careers because they didn't plan on ALSO having additional real-life dreams that have nothing to do with theatre or film or whatever artistic pursuit they are focused on.

Full human beings have lots of life dreams.

Also, dreams will change as you change and grow as an artist and a human being.

Examples of Real-Life Dreams

- Work in a bookstore
- Writer
- Carpentry
- Chef

- Personal Trainer
- Organic Farmer
- Non-profit
- Craft business
- Alterations
- Stylist in a salon

What else can you think of that would make a great side-hustle and also fuel your main career goals in the entertainment industry?

Who Am I?

While you are working out career goals, this is a very good time to find out about yourself.

- Who are you? Get philosophical here.
- What makes you happy?
- What makes you crabby?
- If today you could do anything you want with no repercussions, what would you do?
- What do you care about?
- Do you want to get married some day? Have kids?
- Do you want to stay in Colorado? Travel the world? Relocate to another state?

Myers-Briggs Test (MBT)

It is a GREAT idea to take one—or something similar.

Why? Self-knowledge.

The more you learn about what you prefer (extraversion over introversion, etc.), the easier it will be to match yourself up to a career that will make you happy.

The MBT costs money, but the two other website listed here offer free tests.

- <https://www.myersbriggs.org/>
- <http://www.humanmetrics.com/>

- <https://www.123test.com/>

Money

Time to get real, because we all have to pay the bills.

- How much debt do you have?
- What is it going to cost you to get the training you want for the jobs you want?
- Are you planning on earning degrees or certificates?
- Are you working now?
- What are your current prospects for employment?
- What are your monthly expenses?

Day Job

- If you are working now, what is your job (or jobs)?
- Do you like it? On a scale of 1-10 (1 = Can't wait to quit; 10 = Love it!)
- Any prospects for new employment if you hate your job? What are your options? How is the pay? The hours?

Education

- Do you need more education to realize your dreams?
- Is that college education? Conservatory? Apprenticeships?
- What are your options?
- What are the steps you need to take? (applications, scholarships, etc.)

Service

It's the right thing to do. Just do it.

It will give your life perspective and meaning.

- What is important to you?

- What do you enjoy?
- What do you love?

There is probably a service opportunity that feeds into these questions.

- Love animals? Volunteer at a rescue shelter.
- Social justice warrior? Volunteer for political organizations.
- Like kids? Get involved in an after-school program.
- Respect your elders? Hang out at a retirement center (after covid).
- Like to make things? Volunteer with crafty organizations like Knitting 4 Peace or Masks Now!

The Spread Sheet that Brings it all Together

	A	B	C
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

Organize your spread sheet any way you want. Make it pretty.

Must include: 5 years and the following columns.

	Artistic	Personal	Money	Day Job	Education	Service
2021		Living with my parents	Student Loans: \$5,000 Credit Cards: \$5,000	Subway		Made 100 masks for RRCC Rock the Masks
2022	First paid professional job					
2023					Graduate with an Associates	
2024						
2025		Living in L.A.	Debt Free			

References

Brody, Jane Drake. *The Actor's Business Plan: a Career Guide for the Acting Life*. Bloomsbury, 2017.